

Refunds/Credits Discussion

We have received refund requests for Preschool, All-Day Kindergarten, Pay to Participate, as well as smaller requests such as field trips, parking passes and others. Below I am offering the following guidelines that I would recommend for the district in terms of how we should proceed.

The approximate cost to writing a check for a school district is \$3.00 per check which includes MICR ink, check paper, folding, postage. The fewer of these that we have to write, the better as it is not a simple process for the Treasurer's Office. Each person requesting a refund needs to be added into the financial software before a check can be printed. This is a massive burden on the staff.

I recommend the following in regards to refunds/credits:

1. Apply any refund request **FIRST** to any balance the family may owe the district.
 - a. Unpaid student fees
 - b. Unpaid pay to participate
 - c. Unpaid dues/fines
 - d. Unpaid lunch fees
2. Refunds **under** \$50
 - a. Offer a credit for next year fees or pay to participate.
 - i. Exception – seniors with no other siblings in the district needing a credit can receive a refund.
 - ii. Exception – severe financial hardship request
3. Refunds **over** \$50
 - a. Offer a credit for next year fees or pay to participate (preferred and quickest)
 - b. Offer a refund to
 - i. Seniors with no other siblings in the district needing a credit
 - ii. Anyone with a financial hardship request
4. Donation of refunds to those in need.
 - a. We can donate any refunds by request to those in financial hardship.
 - i. i.e. If a family has \$100 refund due, the parent can also choose to help those in need by making a donation – (unpaid student fees or lunch account).

As stated above, this will be a massive undertaking for the Treasurer's Office and we will process in batches so as not to miss any group. i.e. Preschool, ADK, PTP, etc as the board shall determine.

My office will send an update out each week via social media and email on the status of refunds. Depending on the number of requests and the fact that we are headed towards fiscal year end, this could take 3-4 weeks to complete. We will also need cooperation from all departments involved in order to receive the correct information first, then input vendors, and finally be able to process checks and mail out.